Build Plan

ADHD Budgeting App · how we build the first version, step by step · AI Development Residency, Fall 2026

Words to know: Agile = building in small pieces and changing the plan as we learn. **Sprint** = a 2-week block of work. **MVP** = our first test version, for about 100 invited testers. **Must-have** = a feature the app can't launch without.

How we work: Agile

1 Research → 2 Feature list → 3 Sprint plan → 4 Effort guess → 5 Build and test → 6 Release → 7 Improve

Steps 3 to 5 (in dark blue) repeat every 2 weeks. After each sprint we **show** the new work to 3 to 5 people with ADHD, **look back** at what to improve, and **change the plan** if we learned something.

Each feature is written as a short story, like "I want a bill countdown so bills don't surprise me." We sort the stories into **Must**, **Should**, **Could** and **Won't (for now)**, and build the Musts first.

Our timeline (a best guess we update every sprint)

Step	Weeks	By the end…
Research	1–2	We talk to 8 people with ADHD and sort the feature list
Sprint 1	3–4	People open the app safely with their face or finger
Sprint 2	5–6	People see how much they can safely spend today
Sprint 3	7–8	People add spending in 2 taps and see bills coming
Sprint 4	9–10	People set up in 5 minutes and keep their place
Sprint 5	11–12	People get a fresh start and gentle reminders
Sprint 6	13–14	People link a practice bank (a Could-have)
Release	15	100 adults with ADHD, about half women, start testing
Improve	15–26	We fix their biggest problems, one sprint at a time
Public launch	after	The finished app goes into the app stores

What we build first, and what can wait

Top 5 Must-haves

1. Safe-to-spend number
2. Quick add in 2 taps
3. Bill countdown
4. Fresh start after a break
5. Quick setup that saves your place

If we run late, we drop (in this order)

1. Pause before buying
2. Home-screen widget
3. Bill finder
4. Bank linking

Safety always comes first and is never dropped.

What could go wrong, and our fix

- **Too much to build in time:** we already know what to drop.
- **Not enough testers:** we start finding them in week 6 and aim for 150 sign-ups.
- **The safety work is new to us:** we build it first, in sprint 1.
- **People stop typing in their spending:** we count how often testers log; if it drops, bank linking comes sooner.

A sprint is only "done" when…

- It works on a real phone, and its tests pass.
- Every screen is calm and kind, and works with big text and screen readers.
- The safety checks pass: money data is always locked.

How we'll know it worked

4 in 10 testers still use it after 4 weeks · **6 in 10** come back after a break · setup takes **5 minutes or less** · **30% fewer** late fees by month 3

Sources: MVP Build Plan; one-page Agile plan; Scalevista, "Agile MVP Development Guide"; Spiel et al., CHI 2022 (balanced recruiting).

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